

PSYCHOLOGY · MINDFULNESS · SELF-INQUIRY

Inquiring Deeply

Problems as a Path to Awareness

What if your struggles were showing you the way?

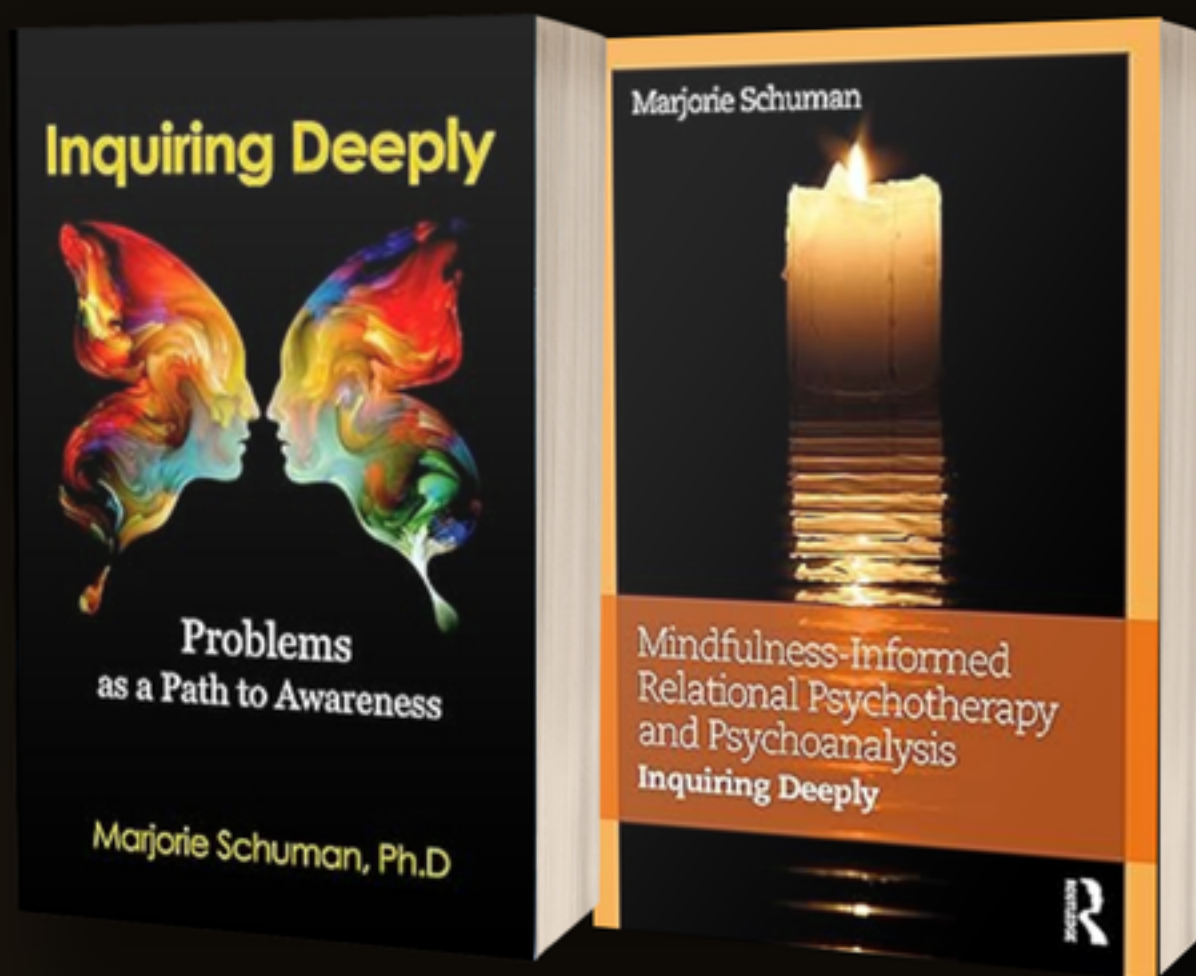
MARJORIE SCHUMAN, PH.D.

Licensed Psychologist · Certified Psychoanalyst
Buddhist Meditation Teacher — Spirit Rock Meditation Center

Also by this Author:

Mindfulness-Informed Relational Psychotherapy and Psychoanalysis

★★★★★ 5-Star Verified Reviews



ABOUT THIS BOOK

What If Your Problems Were the Path?

In Inquiring Deeply, Dr. Marjorie Schuman weaves relational psychoanalysis and mindfulness into a radical reframe: our most persistent problems are not obstacles — they are invitations. Like pain in the body, emotional difficulty calls our attention to what we most need to see.

Through luminous, interconnected essays, this book guides readers toward a deeper relationship with their inner life. Rather than fixing or escaping difficulty, Inquiring Deeply invites us to turn toward it — with curiosity, sustained attention, and genuine compassion.

"Problems are the leading edge of change in our lives."

— Marjorie Schuman, Ph.D.

WHAT MAKES THIS BOOK UNIQUE

Four Pillars of Inquiring Deeply

01

Psychoanalytic Depth

Rooted in relational psychoanalysis — exploring how the mind constructs suffering and how insight genuinely transforms it.

02

Mindfulness Integrated

Mindfulness as lived self-reflective awareness — woven into every layer of understanding, not a bolt-on technique.

03

Essay-Based Wisdom

Interconnected essays, each a meditation in itself — written to be revisited and reflected upon across time and life.

04

A Practical Method

A concrete, lived approach you can apply to any problem — turning difficulty into a genuine pathway of growth.

INSIDE THE BOOK

A Journey Through the Essays

01

The Nature of Problems

Reframing suffering as signal — learning to listen to what difficulty is asking of us.

02

The Inquiring Mind

How sustained curious attention from psychoanalysis and Buddhism opens new dimensions of self.

03

Storyteller Mind

Examining the narratives we build about our lives and how these stories shape emotional reality.

04

Self & Other

Exploring object relations — how we hold relationship in mind, including our own inner life.

05

Problems as Practice

Working with difficulty in the Buddhist sense — discovering the wisdom each struggle contains.

06

Inquiring Deeply

Integrating all threads: how deep self-inquiry catalyzes growth, healing, and expanded awareness.

THE TRANSFORMATION THIS BOOK OFFERS

What You Will Gain



New Relationship with Problems

Stop fighting your difficulties. Start understanding them as teachers pointing toward what you need to see.



Deeper Self-Knowledge

Develop the capacity to look inward with honesty, curiosity, and compassion — hallmarks of genuine growth.



Integrated Awareness

Use psychoanalytic insight and mindfulness together as complementary tools for inner exploration.



Freedom from Repetitive Patterns

Understand why you return to the same emotional loops — and discover what it genuinely takes to shift them.



A Method for Daily Life

Not just philosophy — a lived practice you can apply to any problem, at any moment of the day.



Language for Your Inner Life

Gain a rich vocabulary for emotional experience — articulating what was previously wordless.



MEET THE AUTHOR

Marjorie Schuman, Ph.D.

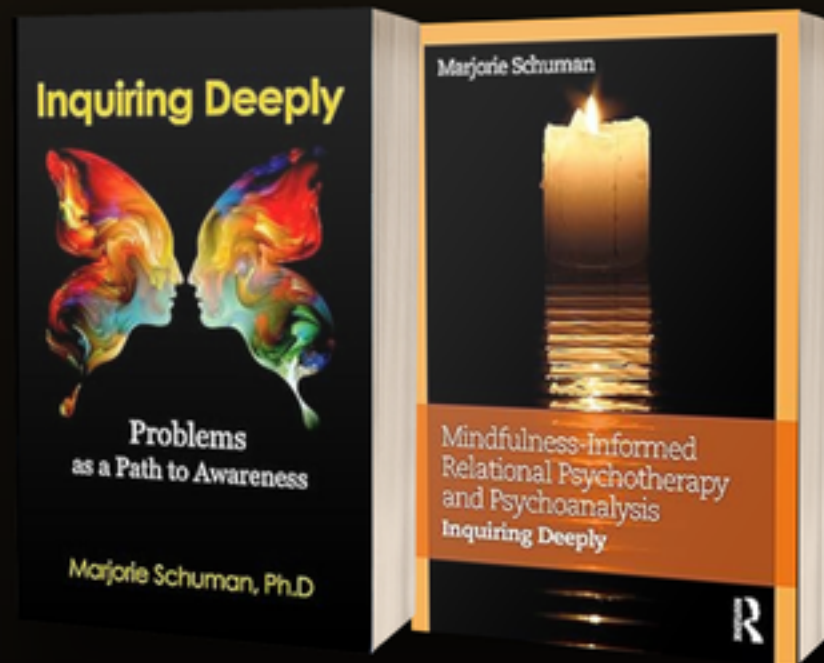
Dr. Schuman is a licensed clinical psychologist and certified psychoanalyst specializing in psychodynamic and relational psychotherapy. She has spent three decades at the intersection of contemporary psychoanalysis and Buddhist insight meditation — integrating both into the self-reflective practice she calls Inquiring Deeply.

| PhD: University of Michigan, Ann Arbor

| Postdoctoral: Dept. of Psychiatry, UCLA

| Psychoanalyst: LA Institute & Society for Psychoanalytic Studies

| Meditation: Spirit Rock — Community Dharma Leader



Also by Marjorie Schuman

THE TRANSFORMATION

Before & After Inquiring Deeply

Without This Book

- ❑ Problems feel like punishment or failure
- ❑ Suffering feels endless and without meaning
- ❑ Stuck in the same emotional patterns
- ❑ Mindfulness and therapy feel disconnected
- ❑ Self-criticism blocks genuine reflection
- ❑ Reading about growth — not living it

With Inquiring Deeply

- ❑ Problems become pathways into deeper self-awareness
- ❑ Suffering reveals where growth and healing are needed
- ❑ Understand patterns at their psychodynamic root
- ❑ An integrated, embodied practice of self-inquiry
- ❑ Curiosity and compassion replace judgment and resistance
- ❑ A method you can apply to any problem, right now

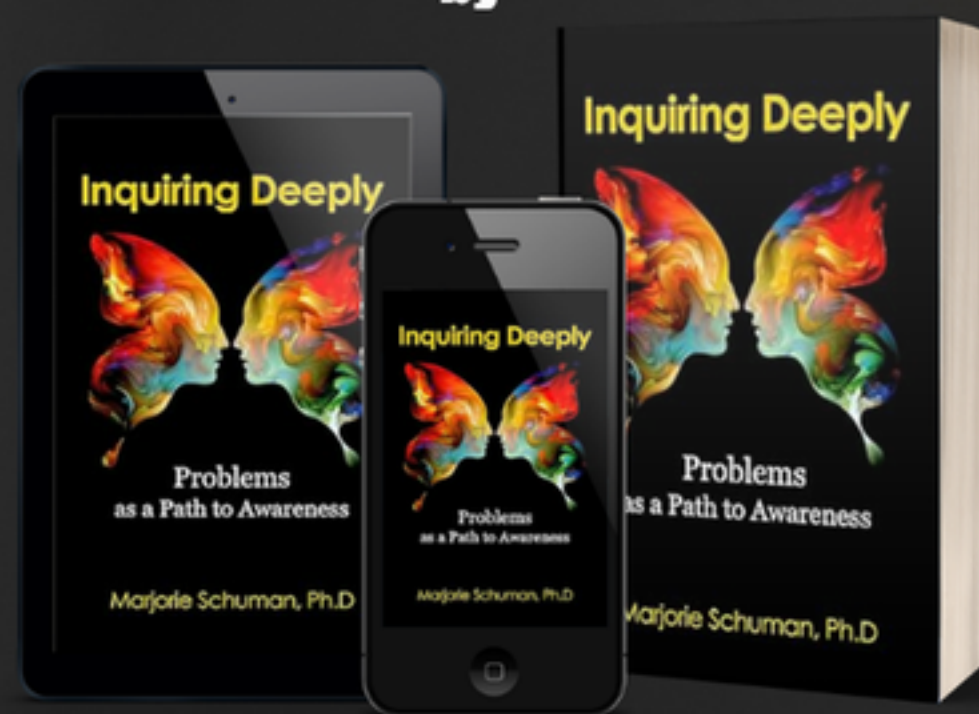
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